

Propaganda on the home front

■ SOURCE INVESTIGATION

All countries fighting the war used propaganda. Sources 17–24 are examples of German propaganda. What can we learn from them about life on the home front? Discuss each poster with a partner and then answer the following questions.

1. a) Which posters use fear to get their message across?
b) Which use patriotism?
c) Which use both fear and patriotism?
2. a) Which posters show optimism?
b) Compare the emotions shown in Sources 17 and 23.
3. a) Explain the alternatives shown in Source 22. b) How does this poster link the Jews with Bolshevism (Communism)?
4. Two of the posters were made towards the end of the war. Which do you think they are and why?
5. Why was it necessary to produce Source 20?
6. a) Which poster do you think delivers its message most effectively?
b) Which is least effective?
Explain your choices.
7. a) What image of Hitler do the posters present?
b) Are they similar to or different from the posters on pages 120–21?



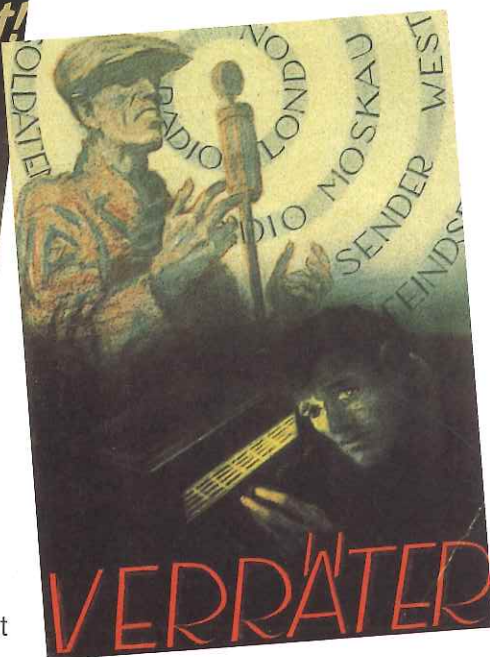
SOURCE 17 A postcard publicising charitable collections for the 'Winter War Aid' campaign



SOURCE 18 A poster warning about the consequences of failing to carry out the black-out



SOURCE 19 An appeal to civilians to use less coal, so it can be used by German industry



SOURCE 20 'Traitor' is how this poster describes anyone listening to foreign radio broadcasts



SOURCE 21 An appeal for co-operation between those working in the armaments factories and those fighting at the front



SOURCE 22 'Victory or Bolshevism' was the choice this poster put before Germany



SOURCE 23 The Volkssturm was a last-ditch defence force



SOURCE 24 Hitler at the front, a painting made in 1942/43

■ ACTIVITY

Some historians argue that the way the Nazis ran Germany was chaotic. Was this true of the home front in Germany? Search pages 140–147 to find examples of good organisation. Remember that every government makes mistakes, especially with the difficulties of war. Ask how well the Nazis tackled problems such as:

- food shortages
- the black market
- bombing
- evacuation
- morale.